GEMMA BOVERY

Details **Originally published** Gemma Bovery (serialised - 1998)
Publisher Jonathan Cape **Writer** Posy Simmonds **Artist** Posy Simmonds
Collected in Gemma Bovery **Available digitally** N/A

Posy Simmonds is the undisputed godmother of British comics.

Perfectly encapsulating middle-class life for *Guardian* readers over the years with her comic strips, Simmonds' first graphic novel, *Gemma Bovery*, was published as a graphic novel following the conclusion of its serialisation.

The last months of the recently deceased Gemma, who had moved to France from London with her husband, are told via the recollections of the local baker, Raymond Joubert, and stolen pages from her journal. Her affairs and desires draw numerous parallels with Gustave Flaubert's *Madame Bovary*, a fact Joubert is aware and frightened of. Part tragi-comedy and part English vs French sensibilities, Simmonds works her magic as the characters twinkle with life among the social satire.

From illustrated text to comic panels and back again, this is undoubtedly Simmonds' greatest work, full of many a home truth and packed with endearingly thought up images.

"PERFECTLY ENCAPSULATES MIDDLE-CLASS LIFE"





